

Rowan Learns Words: Sayings & Inference Game

(v0.1)

Purpose

Practice looking beyond the literal words by using clues, making reasonable guesses, and discussing alternative explanations.

Common Sayings

Where there's smoke, there's fire.

Clues often point to an unseen cause.

Actions speak louder than words.

What people do often tells more than what they say.

You can't judge a book by its cover.

Appearances can be misleading.

Read between the lines.

Look for the message that isn't directly stated.

Connect the dots.

Combine small clues into a larger picture.

Put yourself in someone else's shoes.

Imagine another person's point of view.

The writing is on the wall.

Warning signs have been there for a while.

You reap what you sow.

Today's actions influence tomorrow's results.

A stitch in time saves nine.

Fix small problems before they become large ones.

Don't count your chickens before they hatch.

Don't assume success before it happens.

Inference Detective Game

Instructions: Read the scenario. Decide what probably happened. Explain which clues matter most. Think of another possible explanation. Say what information is missing. Rate your confidence.

Scenario 1: Cookie Jar

Evidence: Cookie jar open, crumbs on counter, dog licking lips.

Questions: 1) What probably happened? 2) Which clue is strongest? 3) Another explanation? 4) What information is missing? 5) How confident are you?

Scenario 2: Wet Umbrella

Evidence: Umbrella dripping by the door, muddy shoes nearby.

Questions: 1) What probably happened? 2) Which clue is strongest? 3) Another explanation? 4) What information is missing? 5) How confident are you?

Scenario 3: Missing Sock

Evidence: One sock missing, dryer just finished, lint trap full.

Questions: 1) What probably happened? 2) Which clue is strongest? 3) Another explanation? 4) What information is missing? 5) How confident are you?

Scenario 4: Broken Vase

Evidence: Vase broken, cat hiding, window open.

Questions: 1) What probably happened? 2) Which clue is strongest? 3) Another explanation? 4)

What information is missing? 5) How confident are you?

Scenario 5: Empty Bird Feeder

Evidence: Feeder empty, birds gathered, seed bag nearby.

Questions: 1) What probably happened? 2) Which clue is strongest? 3) Another explanation? 4) What information is missing? 5) How confident are you?

Scenario 6: Chess Mystery

Evidence: Board set up, one king tipped over, Rowan smiling.

Questions: 1) What probably happened? 2) Which clue is strongest? 3) Another explanation? 4) What information is missing? 5) How confident are you?

Scenario 7: Flat Tire

Evidence: Bike won't roll, nail found on driveway.

Questions: 1) What probably happened? 2) Which clue is strongest? 3) Another explanation? 4) What information is missing? 5) How confident are you?

Scenario 8: Muddy Paws

Evidence: Dog has muddy paws, back door open, clean floor has prints.

Questions: 1) What probably happened? 2) Which clue is strongest? 3) Another explanation? 4) What information is missing? 5) How confident are you?

Scenario 9: Library Book

Evidence: Book missing, backpack half open, library slip on table.

Questions: 1) What probably happened? 2) Which clue is strongest? 3) Another explanation? 4) What information is missing? 5) How confident are you?

Scenario 10: Dead Flashlight

Evidence: Flashlight dim, batteries old, power went out last night.

Questions: 1) What probably happened? 2) Which clue is strongest? 3) Another explanation? 4) What information is missing? 5) How confident are you?